demonstrated it using deep physical insight and crude calculations. Here was an ideal match of talents, Zel'dovich realized. He was just then emerging from his life as an inventor and designer of nuclear weapons and was beginning to build a new team of researchers, a team to work on his newfound love: astrophysics. Novikov, as a master of general relativity, would be an ideal member of the team.

When Novikov, happy at Moscow University, hesitated to sign up, Zel'dovich exerted pressure. He went to Mstislav Keldysh, the director of the Institute of Applied Mathematics where Zel'dovich's team was being assembled; Keldysh telephoned 1van Petrovsky, the *Rektor* (president) of Moscow University, and Petrovsky sent for Novikov. With trepidation Novikov entered Petrovsky's office, high in the central tower of the University, a place to which Novikov had never imagined venturing. Petrovsky was unequivocal: "Maybe you *now* don't want to leave the University to work with Zel'dovich, but you *will* want to." Novikov signed up, and despite some difficult times, never regretted it.

Zel'dovich's style as a mentor for young astrophysicists was the one he had developed while working with his nuclear weapons design team: "Zel'dovich's sparks [ideas] and his team's gasoline"—unless, perchance, some other member of the team could compete in inventing ideas (as Novikov usually did, when relativity was involved). Then Zel'dovich would enthusiastically take up his young colleague's idea and knock it about with the team in a vigorous thrust and parry, bringing the idea quickly to maturity and making it the joint property of himself and its inventor.

Novikov has described Zel'dovich's style vividly. Calling his mentor by first name plus abbreviated patronymic (a form of Russian address that is simultaneously respectful and intimate), Novikov says: "Yakov Boris'ch would often awaken me by telephone at five or six in the morning. T have a new idea! a new idea! Come to my apartment! Let's talk!' I would go, and we would talk for a long, long time. Yakov Boris'ch thought we all could work as long as he. He would work with his team from six in the morning to, say, ten, on one subject. Then a new subject until lunch. After lunch we would take a small walk or exercise or a short nap. Then coffee and more interaction until five or six. In the evening we were freed to calculate, think, or write, in preparation for the next day."

Coddled in his weapons design days, Zel'dovich continued to demand that the world adjust to him: follow his schedule, start work when he